



2026-2027

Wisconsin Junior Open

November 14-15, 2026, Manitowoc, WI

Qualifiers for the 2027 US Open Invitational Tournaments (in Dallas, TX)

SPECIAL
NOTES

- The **High School section winner** will be eligible to participate in the **2027 GM Arnold Denker National Tournament of High School State Champions**.
- The **top finishing girl in the High School section** will be eligible to participate in the **2027 WIM Ruth Haring National Tournament of Girls State Champions**.
- The **top grade 6-8 player in the Middle School section** will be eligible to participate in the **2027 Dewain Barber National Tournament of Middle School State Champions**.
- The **top K-5 finisher in the Elementary School section** will be eligible to participate in the **2027 John D. Rockefeller III National Tournament of Elementary School State Champions**.
- The **top K-3 finisher in the Elementary School section** will be eligible to participate in the **2027 GM Maurice Ashley National Tournament of state K-3 Champions**.

These prestigious national events will be held in Dallas, TX, August 2027. If any ties exist, a series of playoff matches will be held on Sunday night beginning 30 minutes after the last game among the qualifiers is concluded. Format is two G/30; if still tied two G/15; then G/10; then G/5.

FORMAT

The **WJO** is open to players in grade 12 and under. This year's event has a **new format**. There are THREE “Rated” sections: **High School** (grades 9-12), **Middle School** (grades 6-8), and **Elementary School** (grades K-5); *US Chess membership is required in these three sections*. There are also TWO **Non-Rated, Beginner** sections: **Grade K-6** and **Grade 7-12**. These two sections introduce players to more formal play, without requiring US Chess fees. US Chess memberships may be purchased on-site; your Wisconsin Chess Association membership is included in the entry. Our website address is www.wis chess.org. Questions go to: serbach@gmail.com.

PLAYING SITE



The Manitowoc Holiday Inn, 4601 Calumet Ave., Manitowoc, WI, at the intersection of I-43 and US-151. Guest rooms are \$99 for a single night, or **\$139 for a two-night stay**. (The usual hotel tax is extra.) **This special rate is available only until Sunday, Nov. 8th**. These room rates include a **discount on the breakfast buffet**. For reservations you may call (920) 682-6000 (you must mention CHESS); or you may use this link: <https://tinyurl.com/JrVetsHotel>. The web site shows the special \$99 one-night rate for our players. **If you want to stay two nights and get the special \$139 rate**, you need to reserve two nights at \$99 each on-line; then, **when you check in**, the hotel will honor the \$139 rate. (Scan the QR Code to the left.)

REGISTRATION

Players may register in advance online at <https://www.kingregistration.com/register/WIJR2026> (Scan the QR Code to the right). Late registrations accepted at the site from 8:45-9:30 AM on Saturday, November 14. US Chess memberships are available. A Young Adult membership (ages 19-24 at expiration) is \$33. A Youth membership (18 and under at expiration) is \$24. Publication content is available online. A printed copy of the monthly *Chess Life* magazine is an additional \$12. A printed copy of the bi-monthly *Chess Life Kids* is an additional \$6. **Please bring your chess clock**. Chess sets and boards are provided **for the playing room only!** Phone inquiries: Steve Erbach at (920) 279-5688 before Friday, November 13, or e-mail: [Steve Erbach \(serbach@gmail.com\)](mailto:Steve.Erbach@serbach@gmail.com).



SCHEDULE

The 2026-2027 Wisconsin Junior Open is a **five-round** Swiss-System event. **Under Swiss rules, all entrants play five games!** Rounds start at 10:15 AM, 2:30 PM, and 7:15 PM Saturday; Sunday rounds at 10:00 AM and 3:00 PM. The time control is Game/90 with a 30-second increment. One half-point bye is available for round 1, 2, 3 or 4 if requested with your advance entry, or at Late Registration on-site.

ENTRY FEES

If received by Tuesday, November 10th, the early entry fees are: High School, Middle School, & Elementary School sections: \$30. Beginner Grade 7-12 and Grade K-6 sections: \$25. After November 10th, entries are \$5 more. If you enter on <https://www.kingregistration.com/register/WIJR2026>, there is an additional fee to cover processing costs.

Mail entry fees (check or money order; *no credit cards*) along with **1)** your name, **2)** street address, **3)** email, **4)** phone, **5)** birthdate, **6)** grade, and **7)** school. If you're entering one of the rated sections then we also need your **8)** USCF ID number.

Mail your advance entries so that they arrive by November 10th, to: **Steve Erbach, Tournament Organizer**, 939 Lincoln Blvd., Manitowoc, WI 54220. Also, **9)** please indicate whether you want a half-point bye in round 1, 2, 3, or 4 (only one bye is available).

After November 10th, all entry fees are \$5 more.

If you pre-register but then cannot play, your entry will be refunded (*less any King Registration service fees*) only if you notify the tournament director by 9:30 AM on November 14th.

PRIZES

Sixty top-quality marble-base trophies are guaranteed for the following place and rating class prizes:

- High School:** Top five places, top Class ‘C’ (1400-1599), ‘D’ (1200-1399), 1st & 2nd 1000-1199, 1st & 2nd 800-999, 1st & 2nd 600-799, 1st & 2nd 400-599, Under 400, 1st & 2nd Unrated, and Top Girl.
- Middle School:** Top five places, top Class ‘D’ (1200-1399), Top 1000-1199, Top 800-999, Top 600-799, Top 400-599, Top Under 400, Top Unrated, and Top Girl.
- Elementary School:** Top five places, top 1000-1199, top 800-999, top 600-799, top 400-599, top Under 400, top Unrated, and Top Girl.
- Non-Rated Beginner Grade 7-12:** Top five places overall, and 1st, 2nd, & 3rd in combined grades 7-9.
- Non-Rated Beginner Grade K-6:** Top five places overall, and 1st, 2nd, & 3rd in combined grades K-3.

All prizes will be awarded **at the site** after the final round. In case of ties, trophies will be awarded based on Solkoff, Cumulative, Sum of Opponent’s Cumulative and Sonneborn-Berger tie-break systems.